

Week 9: Dater et mesurer le temps

JSS3 French — First Term Lesson Note (Deep-Dive Edition)

Introduction

This week teaches students how to give the date and the time in French, and how to use common time expressions — essential for scheduling, storytelling, and everyday conversation.

Donner la date (Giving the Date)

- **Quel jour sommes-nous?** (What day is it?) → **Nous sommes lundi.** (It's Monday.)
- **Quelle est la date aujourd'hui?** (What is today's date?) → **Nous sommes le 15 septembre.** (It's the 15th of September.)

Les jours: lundi, mardi, mercredi, jeudi, vendredi, samedi, dimanche

Les mois: janvier, février, mars, avril, mai, juin, juillet, août, septembre, octobre, novembre, décembre

Donner l'heure (Giving the Time)

- **Quelle heure est-il?** (What time is it?)
- **Il est trois heures.** (It is three o'clock.)
- **Il est trois heures et quart.** (It is quarter past three.)
- **Il est trois heures et demie.** (It is half past three.)
- **Il est quatre heures moins le quart.** (It is quarter to four.)

Expressions temporelles (Time Expressions)

Français	English
dans (deux jours)	in (two days) — future
il y a (deux jours)	(two days) ago — past
pendant (une heure)	for/during (an hour)
depuis (lundi)	since (Monday)

Exemples

Nous sommes le 10 octobre. Il est neuf heures et demie. (It's the 10th of October. It's half past nine.)

Le match commence dans deux heures. (The match starts in two hours.)

J'ai fini mes devoirs il y a une heure. (I finished my homework an hour ago.)

Real-Life Application

This topic is essential for practical situations such as arranging a meeting time, describing a school timetable, or talking about when an event happened — all common tasks in BECE oral French examinations.

Evaluation Questions

- 1 Translate into French: "What time is it?"
- 2 Write the time "4:30" in French words.
- 3 Write the time "quarter to six" in French.
- 4 Name the seven days of the week in French, in order.
- 5 Translate into French: "Today is the 3rd of March."
- 6 Give the French word for "in" (future) and "ago" (past) as time expressions.
- 7 Translate into English: "J'habite ici depuis cinq ans."
- 8 Write a sentence using "il y a" to describe something that happened in the past.
- 9 Write a sentence using "pendant" to describe how long an activity lasted.
- 10 Write today's date and the current time in full French sentences.